Module 0- Soft Skills

Objective: To develop an understanding of soft and hard skills, their significance, and the ability to identify them in practical contexts.

Real-life Context (Nokia Example)
Discussed Nokia's rise, challenges, and lessons learned.

Observations:

Observation Points	Skills Observed	Opinion
Technical expertise in mobile technology	Hard Skills	
Leadership and adaptability	Soft Skills	
Market awareness	Soft Skills	

Instruction: Share your opinion on the observation point and skills observed. (Based on Nokia's Experience)

Conceptual Understanding

Soft Skills
Soft skills are interpersonal and intrapersonal skills that help individuals behave and perform effectively in personal, social, and professional contexts.

Key Soft Skills: Positive attitude, communication (verbal and non-verbal), teamwork, adaptability, problem-solving, and emotional intelligence.

Hard Skills
Hard skills are technical, measurable abilities learned through training or formal education.
Examples: Programming, machine operation, accounting, medical procedures

Difference between Hard Skills and Soft Skills

Hard Skills	Soft Skills
Technical	Interpersonal, intrapersonal
Measurable	Behaviour-based
Taught through training	Developed through experience
Job specific	Job flexible

Case Study 1: Dr. Devi Shetty

Questions
Q1. Who is Dr. Devi Shetty?

_____

_____

_____

Q2. What are his hard skills / technical expertise?

_____

_____

_____

Q3. What are his soft skills / leadership qualities?

_____

_____

_____

Q4. What can students learn from him?

_____

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Summary Table: Other Leaders

	Leader	Hard Skills	Soft Skills	Key Observation / Lesson
Case Study 2	Abraham Lincoln	Legal knowledge, political strategy	Communication, patience, integrity	Leadership requires strong interpersonal skills
Case Study 3	Jeff Immelt	Business strategy, financial management	Adaptability, teamwork, problem-solving	Soft skills complement technical expertise for organizational success

Reflection

After studying the leadership journeys of Dr. Devi Shetty, Abraham Lincoln, and Jeff Immelt:

1. What do you understand about the importance of soft skills in achieving success?

_____

_____

_____

Importance of Soft Skills ***(Use this as your reference for the above question)***

- Soft skills play a significant role in navigating professional, social, and personal relationships.
- Crucial for career growth and satisfaction.
- In future workplaces, while technical skills may be automated, emotional intelligence, empathy, creativity, and adaptability will become even more important.

2. How can you apply these skills in your personal and professional life?

_____

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UNIT I: Analytical Thinking and Listening Skills

Objective: To develop analytical thinking and effective listening skills through experiential learning activities that promotes self-awareness, accurate perception, positive attitude, and purposeful verbal and non-verbal communication.

Module 1: Self-Introduction

Objective:
To develop the ability to present oneself confidently and effectively, conveying relevant personal, academic, and professional information.

Overview: A self-introduction is the first step in presenting oneself in academic, social, and professional settings. It communicates who we are, what we do, and what we value. A clear and confident introduction reflects communication skills, self-awareness, and the ability to connect with others.

Importance

- Builds verbal communication skills, clarity of thought, and confidence
- Useful in interviews, group discussions, presentations, team activities, and daily interactions
- A good self-introduction is brief, relevant, and structured, giving a clear picture of background, achievements, skills, and aspirations

Professional Self-Introduction Guidelines

1. **Professional Identity:** Branch, year, or role
2. **Knowledge:** What you know or are currently learning
3. **Skills:** Projects, labs, tools, or certifications
4. **Attitude / Soft Skills:** Revealed through actions, behavior, or mindset
5. **Optional Goal / Forward-Looking Statement:** Future aspirations or aims

Delivery Tips

- Speak clearly at a moderate pace
- Maintain eye contact and use appropriate gestures
- Keep a warm, enthusiastic voice
- Avoid memorization; stay natural and confident
- Keep it brief and structured

Self Introduction

Note: Write your Self Introduction here.

_____
_____
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Module 2.1 – Listening: Shaping Young Minds (Azim Premji)

Objective: To improve listening skills and analytical thinking by listening to Azim Premji's speech *"Shaping Young Minds"* and understanding its key ideas and values.
Listening Comprehension Activity

1. Listening Comprehension Questions

A. What is the first lesson Azim Premji says he learned in life?

_____

_____

B. Why does he emphasize that a rupee earned honestly is more valuable than easy money?

_____

_____

C. What does Azim Premji say about success and failure in life?

_____

_____

D. What key point does Azim Premji make about values such as honesty and humility?

_____

_____

E. What is the difference between responding and reacting, according to the speaker?

_____

2. Analytical Questions

A. Why does the speaker say "no one bats a hundred runs every time," and what message does it give about success and failure?

_____

_____

B. What is the overall tone of the speaker?

_____

_____

2. Application & Reflection
   C. How can Azim Premji's message be applied to the academic and professional lives of today's youngsters?

_____

_____

Key Takeaways

- Listening is not just hearing; it is **understanding, analyzing, and reflecting**.
- Self-development grows when we **apply lessons from real-life role models**.
- Values such as honesty, humility, optimism, and resilience are crucial for **personal and professional growth**.
- Pausing before responding helps in **better decision-making, teamwork, and professional relationships**.

Module 2.2 Self-Analysis

Objective: To help understand oneself by identifying strengths, weaknesses, opportunities, and threats through self-reflection.

SWOT

Strengths are the positive qualities, abilities, or resources that a person possesses and performs effectively.
Weaknesses are personal limitations or habits that reduce effectiveness or need improvement.
Opportunities are external situations, support, or chances that can be used for growth and progress.
Threats are external challenges or obstacles that may hinder success or development.

SWOT Analysis (Paste the SWOT Google Form Response Sheet- Available in your e-mail)

Follow-Up Action Sheet

1. Your SWOT Scores

Category	**Average Score (1–5)**	Meaning
Strengths		Things you do well; leverage these in placements
Weaknesses		Areas to improve; focus on these first
Opportunities		External chances to grow; use them
Threats		Challenges to watch; plan to overcome

2. Quick Reflection

- **Top Strength: _____**
- **Top Weakness: _____**
- **Key Opportunity to Act On: _____**
- **Main Threat to Manage: _____**

3. Action Plan for Improving Weakness (Example- In Place of this Example action Plan, Write your own Action Plan)

What to Do	**How**	**Timeline**
Example: Improve public speaking	Join club / practice 5 mins/day	2 weeks
Example: Update technical skills	Take online course	1 month
Example: Networking	Connect with alumni / LinkedIn	1 month
Example: Time management	Daily planner / set priorities	2 weeks

4. Key Takeaways

- Use strengths in interviews and teamwork
- Work on 1–2 weaknesses at a time
- Leverage opportunities actively
- Be aware of threats but don't be stressed

Module 2.3: Positive Attitude

Objective: To develop a habit of thinking positively, staying confident, and handling challenges in a calm and constructive way.

Developing a Positive Attitude
(Using Insights from Azim Premji's "Shaping Young Minds" Speech)

Part A: Listening Comprehension

1. How did the girl feel when she cooked her own breakfast? What does this teach about effort?

   _____

   _____

2. What does Premji mean when he says, "No one bats a hundred every time"?

   _____

   _____

3. Which part of the speech reminds you to be grateful or humble?

   _____

   _____

B. Definition: A positive attitude is the mental habit of focusing on the good in every situation, believing in your ability to overcome challenges, and responding with optimism and confidence. It is not about ignoring difficulties but about approaching them constructively.

C. Key Features of a Positive Attitude

1. Optimism: Looking for solutions rather than dwelling on problems.
2. Resilience: Recovering quickly from setbacks.
3. Confidence: Trusting in your skills and decisions.
4. Proactive Behaviour: Taking initiative to improve situations.
5. Gratitude: Appreciating what you have and acknowledging others' efforts.
6. Solution-Focused Thinking: Concentrating on actions that lead to progress.

D. Importance of a Positive Attitude

- Reduces stress and improves mental well-being.
- Enhances productivity and decision-making.
- Strengthens relationships through cooperation and empathy.
- Encourages continuous learning and personal growth.

Part E: Application and Reflection

1. **Map the insights from Azim Premji's speech to positive attitude traits.**

Question	Insights	Positive Attitude Trait Observed
1	Felt proud and responsible	Proactive behavior Confidence Solution-focused thinking
2	Everyone makes mistakes, learn from failure	Resilience Optimism
3	Appreciate small efforts, value others	Gratitude, Humility

2. One challenge you faced recently and how a positive attitude helps:

_____

_____

3. How can a positive attitude can help you as an engineering student:

_____

_____

Module 2.4: Perception

Objective: To understand perception and apply it through observation and reflection.

1. Activity: Observing Perception

(Observe the images, note your first perception and compare with others)

Step 1.1: Individual Observation (Record in One Word)

1. Rabbit/Bird image: _____
2. Elephant legs image: _____

Step 1.2: Reflection (Write as a short paragraph)

Rabbit & Bird Image: Some see the rabbit first, others the bird. This is because our brain focuses on patterns or shapes that stand out, influenced by prior experience, expectations, and attention. Both perspectives are valid.

Elephant Legs Illusion: The number of legs seems confusing. Our brain fills in missing or ambiguous information, so people may perceive different numbers of legs.

2, Understanding Perception

1. **Perception:** How we interpret events, people, and situations, influenced by past experiences, emotions, assumptions, and biases.
2. **Why we see things differently:** Attention, mindset, and prior experience shape what we notice first.
3. **Key Idea:** Perception is subjective; awareness of multiple perspectives helps in decision-making, problem-solving, and relationships.

3. Applying Accurate Perception

- **Pause and Reflect:** Consider facts and others' perspectives before responding.
- **Observe Carefully:** Notice tone, expressions, and gestures.
- **Seek Multiple Perspectives:** Talk to others before forming opinions; avoid assumptions.
- **Self-Reflection:** Check how emotions or biases influence your perception.

4. Activity: Comprehension

What is the difference between reacting and responding, according to Premji? Give an example.

_____

_____

Why is it important to evaluate a situation calmly before taking action?

_____

_____

5. Application

Recall a situation where you reacted impulsively. How could responding calmly have changed the outcome?

6. Key Takeaways

- Perception is the lens through which we understand the world.
- Pausing, observing, and thinking clearly helps us respond wisely, leading to better decisions, improved relationships, and effective communication.

Module 3: Communication Skills

Objective: To develop the ability to express ideas clearly and listen effectively, using words, body language, and tone to create understanding and connect with others.

Communication Skills

Communication skills are the abilities used to share information, ideas, thoughts, and feelings to create understanding between individuals. Effective communication involves not only what is said or written but also how it is expressed through voice, body language, and behaviour.

Types of Communication

Communication can broadly be classified into Verbal Communication and Non-Verbal Communication.

I. Verbal Communication

Verbal communication uses words to convey messages and is further divided into Oral Communication and Written Communication.

A. Oral Communication

Oral communication refers to spoken interaction in academic, professional, and social contexts. It plays a crucial role in discussions, presentations, interviews, and teamwork.

Key Aspects of Oral Communication

- Clarity of speech and pronunciation
- Appropriate tone and voice modulation
- Moderate pace and fluency
- Use of polite and professional language
- Logical organization of ideas
- Active listening and relevant responses
- Confidence while speaking

B. Written Communication

Written communication involves expressing ideas in written form and is essential for professional documentation, emails, applications, and academic writing.

Key Aspects of Written Communication

- Clear and simple sentence construction
- Logical organization of ideas
- Correct grammar and sentence structure
- Appropriate vocabulary and professional tone
- Coherence and clarity of expression
- Proper spelling and punctuation
- Editing and revision before submission

Paragraph Writing

II. Non-Verbal Communication

Non-verbal communication conveys messages without words. Body language, a key component, reflects attitudes, emotions, and confidence, and supports or modifies verbal communication.

Key Elements of Body Language

- **Kinesics**: Study of body movements such as facial expressions, gestures, posture, and eye contact.
- **Haptics**: Communication through touch, such as handshakes or pats, showing support or formality.
- **Proxemics**: Use of personal space to indicate intimacy, formality, or authority.
- **Oculesics**: Use of eye contact to show attention, confidence, and sincerity.
- **Paralanguage**: Voice features like tone, pitch, pace, and pause that support spoken words.
- **Chronemics**: Use of time, punctuality, and response speed in communication.
- **Appearance and artifacts**: Clothing, grooming, and accessories that influence impressions.

Important Aspects of Body Language

- Sit upright with relaxed shoulders to show confidence
- Maintain steady, natural eye contact while speaking and listening
- Use a firm but polite handshake (if appropriate)
- Nod occasionally to show attentiveness
- Keep hands visible; avoid excessive gestures
- Avoid fidgeting, touching face, or tapping
- Lean slightly forward to show interest
- Maintain professional distance
- Smile naturally when greeting and responding
- Wear neat, formal attire with proper grooming

These cues help convey confidence, openness, and professionalism during presentations, discussions, and interviews.

Note: Briefly write about Consumption and Contribution discussed in the class. Based on the discussion give the evaluation of the four students followed by your self reflection.

Model table :

Student Name	Verbal Communication	Non-Verbal Communication	Suggestions for Improvement
A	Clear and confident	Upright posture, good eye contact	Improve voice modulation
B	Brief but relevant	Attentive posture, nodding	Participate more actively
C	Fluent and polite	Slouched posture at times	Maintain posture
D	Minimal but polite	Good eye contact, fidgeting	Contribute verbally

Self reflection

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Key Takeaway
Effective communication skills enhance understanding, build confidence, and create positive impressions in academic, professional, and interview settings. The combined use of oral, written, and non-verbal communication helps convey messages clearly and professionally.

Self-Introduction : Reflection and Insights

Objective:
To present oneself confidently and reflect on strengths, communication, and areas for improvement.

Write your self introduction here based on perception , positive attitude and communication

Self Introduction

Self-Reflection

Prompts:

- What went well in my self-introduction?
- What can I improve next time?
- How did my self-awareness, attitude, and perception influence my introduction?
- Which traits or skills did I emphasize, and why?

Key Takeaway:

- Reflection helps students connect self-knowledge to communication.
- Encourages continuous improvement